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ST. ANN'S COLLEGE FOR WOMEN

Run by The Society of St Anne

Affiliated to Acharya Nagarjuna University, Approved by AICTE

Recognised under Section 2(f) of the UGC Act 1956, New Delhi.

Accredited by NAAC with 'A' Grade in the first cycle

Amaravathi Road, Gorantla, Guntur-34, Andhra Pradesh, India.



Website: www.stannscollegeforwomen.ac.in

CHAPTER – IV

HUMAN RESOURCE POLICY

1. APPOINTMENT OF LEADERSHIP

The Principals, Secretaries cum Correspondents and Deans of Higher Educational Institutions who are members of the Society shall be appointed by the President / Chairperson of the Governing Body, in formal consultation with its members.

4.1. APPOINTMENT OF TEACHING AND NON-TEACHING STAFF

1. Governing Framework

The appointment of staff within Institutions administered by the Society is governed by the terms stipulated in the individual Letter of Appointment, as well as the prevailing service rules and regulations of the Education Society. These documents define the legal rights, duties, and service conditions of the employee.

2. Appointing Authority

The Governing Body serves as the ultimate appointing authority. It shall exercise this power through the Correspondent or Principal for all categories of Institutional Employees.

3. Selection Committee

A Selection Committee comprising four to five members including subject matter experts, the Correspondent, the Principal, and faculty representatives nominated by Management shall be constituted. All appointments must strictly adhere to UGC, NCTE, AICTE, and SCERT norms, alongside relevant University and Government guidelines.

4. Status of Employment

Completion of a contract period does not automatically entitle an employee to confirmation or permanent status. Permanent employment is granted only upon the satisfactory fulfilment of all contractual obligations and the successful completion of the prescribed probationary period.

4.2. RECRUITMENT PROCEDURE

1. Notification of Vacancies

The Correspondent is responsible for notifying the Employment Exchange of vacancies (where applicable) and advertising vacant positions in local daily newspapers to invite applications.

2. Application Processing

The Correspondent of the respective institution shall receive all applications. Following a preliminary scrutiny, only eligible candidates will be invited for an interview at their own expense.

3. Interview Process

The Selection Committee shall conduct interviews for shortlisted candidates. Selection will be based on merit, encompassing performance in both a teaching demonstration and a personal interview.

4. Selection Criteria

Due consideration shall be given to academic qualifications, professional experience, and the candidate's overall suitability for the role.

5. Preferential Consideration

The Committee shall recommend a panel of candidates for each post, arranged in order of merit. In alignment with the Society's mission, due preference may be given to Catholic candidates.

6. Issuance of Orders

All selections made by the Committee shall be submitted to the Correspondent, who is authorized to sign and issue the formal Appointment Orders.

7. Contractual Nature

New appointments are initially made on a contractual basis for eleven months or until the end of the academic year, whichever is earlier. Upon the expiration of this term, the contract stands automatically terminated.

8. Employment Agreement

Upon accepting the offer, the selected candidate must execute an agreement with the institution in the prescribed format.

9. Service Credits

Prior service rendered in institutions outside the St. Ann's network shall not be considered for pension or other service-related benefits.

10. Remuneration Note

During the initial contractual period, employees are not entitled to salary payments during the summer vacation.

4.3. APPOINTMENT OF SUBSTITUTE TEACHERS

The Correspondent is empowered to fill temporary vacancies arising from resignations, maternity leave, prolonged illness, or study leave to ensure institutional continuity.

4.4. REQUIRED CERTIFICATES AND DOCUMENTATION

All appointed candidates must submit the following original documents (or certified copies) to the Correspondent:

- **Proof of Age:** SSC Certificate or equivalent.
- **Academic Qualifications:** Graduation and post-graduation certificates (e.g., B.A., B.Com, B.Sc., M.A., M.Sc., Ph.D.).
- **Professional Eligibility:** Training certificates and NET/SLET qualification documents.
- **Experience:** Relevant service certificates from previous employers, if applicable.

4.5. CONTRACTUAL APPOINTMENT

i. Definition of Tenure

An employee is deemed to be under contract upon the successful completion of two years of service within a cumulative period of two to three years. This tenure accounts for a one-month hiatus during the summer vacation.

ii. Remuneration

Throughout the contractual period, the employee shall receive a consolidated salary as determined by the Correspondent of the institution.

iii. Limitations on Advancement

During the contract period, employees are ineligible for salary increments or claims for promotion.

iv. Regularization

Employment may be transitioned to a regular status solely at the discretion of the management, contingent upon satisfactory performance and professional conduct.

v. Termination and Evaluation

The management reserves the right to terminate an employee's services without prior notice or stated cause. Furthermore, a letter of regularization shall only be issued following a comprehensive performance evaluation conducted by a committee appointed by the Governing Body.

4.6. REGULARIZATION OF SERVICES

The Correspondent may regularize the services of a contractual employee provided the candidate satisfies the following criteria. The local Correspondent or Principal must submit a formal confidential report verifying that:

- i. No significant grievances have been lodged against the employee by parents or students.
- ii. There are no pending disciplinary allegations or formal charges.
- iii. The individual's professional performance remains consistently satisfactory.
- iv. The individual demonstrates exemplary character and ethical conduct.
- v. The individual strictly adheres to all institutional rules and regulations.

4.7. PAY SCALES

The remuneration for both teaching and non-teaching staff shall be administered in accordance with the established norms of St. Ann's Society or the specific pay scales prescribed by the respective independent Society of St. Ann's Educational Institutions.

4.8. ALLOWANCES AND INCREMENTS

The Governing Body shall determine all allowances subject to the following conditions:

i. Fiscal Interdependence

Given that staff remuneration is funded by student tuition fees, and that institutional revenue is directly linked to enrollment, adjustments to the Dearness Allowance (D.A.) shall be announced only once per academic year (in June). D.A. and other benefits are determined by the financial solvency of each specific institution; consequently, uniformity in allowances across all St. Ann's Society institutions is not guaranteed.

ii. Discretionary Increments

No employee is entitled to annual or periodic increments as a matter of right. Such adjustments are strictly contingent upon the institution's financial health and future fiscal projections.

iii. Suspension of Benefits

Notwithstanding any existing pay scales or increment structures, the employer reserves the right to suspend or defer increments, either for individuals or specific categories of staff due to economic recession or other valid institutional exigencies.

iv. Salary Caps

In consideration of financial constraints, the Management reserves the right to impose a ceiling on the salaries of teaching faculty.

4.9. RECORD OF AGE AND IDENTITY

The Management shall verify and maintain a formal record of every employee's age. The following documents are considered authoritative and satisfactory proof of age:

i. Statutory Certificates

A birth certificate issued by a Municipal Corporation, Municipality, Panchayat, the Registrar of Births and Deaths, or the educational institution most recently attended.

ii. Educational Records

A valid School Leaving Certificate (SLC) or equivalent academic transfer document.

iii. Government Identification

A valid Passport, Aadhaar card, or Ration Card issued by the Government of India.

iv. Right to Rectification

The Management reserves the right to amend an employee's official age record at any time should it be discovered that the documents provided were fraudulent or forged. Any such corrections shall be implemented only after providing due notice to the concerned employee.

v. Finality of Records

The age verified and recorded by the Management based on the aforementioned documentation shall be deemed final, conclusive, and binding for all employment-related matters, including retirement and statutory benefits.

CHAPTER – VI

INSTITUTIONAL CODE OF CONDUCT

6.1. GENERAL SCOPE

These rules apply to all employees, both teaching and non-teaching, of St. Ann's Institutions, irrespective of their type of appointment. Adherence to these standards is mandatory for all staff members.

6.2. IDENTIFICATION AND RECORDS

- **Identity Cards:** Every employee will be issued an ID card, which must be worn at all times on the college premises. The ID card must be presented upon request by Management.
- **Surrender of ID:** Upon cessation of employment, the ID card must be returned to the Appointing Authority before final accounts are settled.
- **Replacement:** Lost or damaged ID cards will be replaced upon payment of a prescribed fee.
- **Address Updates:** Employees must notify the administration of any change in local or permanent address within 3 days. Official communications sent to the recorded address will be deemed legally served.

6.3. MAINTENANCE OF DISCIPLINE

Employees are expected to function as a disciplined team, prioritizing the institution's academic mission over personal opinions.

Staff shall:

1. **Model Integrity:** Serve as role models, upholding the "noble profession" of education through absolute integrity and devotion to duty.
2. **Prohibit Subversion:** Refrain from inciting, abetting, or encouraging students to engage in acts of indiscipline or activities detrimental to the institution.
3. **Ensure Availability:** Remain at the disposal of the institution and avoid unauthorized absences.
4. **Uphold Professional Conduct:** Abstain from smoking or the use of intoxicants on campus.
5. **Respect Authority:** Comply with all lawful orders and instructions from supervisors.

6. **Protect Property:** Be responsible for the safekeeping and proper maintenance of institutional assets.
7. **Collaborate:** Foster cooperation with colleagues and non-teaching staff to ensure efficient operations.
8. **Prohibit Private Tuition:** Refrain from providing unauthorized private coaching or tuitions.
9. **Communicate Respectfully:** Use professional language and avoid any derogatory or abusive speech.
10. **Manage Misbehavior:** Use academic corrections rather than corporal punishment. Serious indiscipline should be referred to the Principal and Discipline Committee.
11. **Maintain Confidentiality:** Do not disclose official documents or internal information to outsiders or the press without explicit Management approval.
12. **Staff Room Privacy:** Ensure that no unauthorized visitors or outsiders enter the staff room.

6.4. PROFESSIONAL NORMS

- **Ethics:** Maintain the highest standards of professional ethics; honesty and impartiality must be beyond reproach.
- **Fair Assessment:** Avoid gross partiality, victimization, or the deliberate over-marking or under-marking of students.
- **Academic Integrity:** Any involvement in or encouragement of examination malpractice is strictly prohibited.

6.5. ATTENDANCE AND PUNCTUALITY

- **Punctuality:** Employees must report for duty at the appointed hour.
- **Late Arrival:** Entry after the scheduled time, up to 30 minutes, is at the Principal's discretion.
- **Penalties:** For every three instances of late attendance, one day of Casual Leave (C.L.) shall be forfeited.
- **Unauthorized Absence:** Employees absenting themselves without reasonable cause or refusing to work while present will face disciplinary action.
- **Disciplinary Oversight:** Notwithstanding salary forfeiture, the Management reserves the right to initiate disciplinary proceedings for chronic absenteeism.

EMPLOYEE CODE OF CONDUCT & SERVICE RULES

6.6. PRIVATE EMPLOYMENT & FINANCIAL INTEGRITY

- **Confidentiality:** Employees must not disclose proprietary information regarding the Institution's finances, services, or internal operations to unauthorized parties.
- **Prohibited Trade:** Engaging in private trade or business on institutional premises is strictly forbidden.
- **Exclusive Service:** Employees shall not accept external employment or assignments, whether salaried or honorary, during their tenure without prior written consent.
- **Financial Probity:** Unauthorized collection of funds from students is prohibited; all financial transactions must be sanctioned by the Head of the Institution.

6.7. LABOR RELATIONS & GRIEVANCES

- **Unionization:** The formation of trade unions is not permitted.
- **Conflict Resolution:** Grievances must be directed to the Correspondent, who will facilitate a resolution through empathetic dialogue.
- **Undue Influence:** Employees shall not leverage political pressure or external associations to influence Management regarding service matters.

6.8. PUBLIC CONDUCT & ETHICS

- **Professionalism:** Employees must maintain decorum and treat students, parents, and colleagues with respect.
- **Orderliness:** Inciting disorderly conduct or organizing unauthorized meetings during working hours is prohibited.
- **Zero Tolerance:** Violence, moral turpitude, and property damage are grounds for immediate disciplinary action.
- **Inclusivity:** The Institution strictly prohibits the propagation of casteism, communalism, or any form of discrimination based on origin, creed, or social background.

6.9. NO WORK, NO PAY PRINCIPLE

The principle of “**No Work, No Pay**” shall apply to all instances of unauthorized absence or failure to discharge assigned duties, without prejudice to further disciplinary action.

6.10. WORKING HOURS & FLEXIBILITY

- **Operational Needs:** Standard working hours may vary by department. Employees are expected to work beyond scheduled hours if exigencies demand.
- **Shift Adjustments:** Management reserves the right to alter shifts or hours to meet institutional requirements.
- **Professional Exclusivity:** Staff may not practice in their professional field outside the Institution without explicit written authorization.

6.11. PROFESSIONAL OBLIGATIONS

- **Interpersonal Conduct:** Every staff member must remain courteous and considerate toward all stakeholders.
- **Conscientious Performance:** Duties must be executed with diligence, following the instructions of superiors and fostering a spirit of cooperation.
- **Stewardship of Assets:** Employees are responsible for the care of institutional property. Damage resulting from negligence or misuse may lead to recovery of costs from the employee's salary.
- **Incident Reporting:** All workplace injuries must be reported immediately to the principal to ensure timely medical attention and documentation.

6.12. SAFETY AND RISK MANAGEMENT

- **Mandatory Reporting:** Staff must immediately report any defects or occurrences to the principal that could endanger lives or damage institutional property.
- **Preventive Action:** All employees are responsible for following safety protocols and using the safety devices provided as prescribed by Management.

6.13. TERMINATION OF PERMANENT EMPLOYEES

The Appointing Authority may terminate a permanent employee by providing three months' notice or three months' salary in lieu of notice under the following conditions:

- **Disciplinary Action:** Following a legal inquiry for proven misconduct.
- **Administrative Grounds:** If deemed in the best interest of the Institution.
- **Legal Compliance:** In accordance with state laws.
- **Medical Grounds:** Based on specific health criteria detailed in Chapter VII.

6.14. RESIGNATION PROCEDURES

- **Notice Period:** Employees may resign by providing the required notice or paying salary in lieu.
- **Handover:** Resigning staff are officially relieved only after all charges and responsibilities are handed over to a designated colleague.
- **Employer Rights:** The Institution may refuse a resignation if disciplinary proceedings are currently pending.
- **Documentation:** Every permanent employee is entitled to a Service Certificate upon departure.

6.15. RETIREMENT (SUPERANNUATION)

- **Statutory Retirement:** The mandatory retirement age is 58 years.
- **Voluntary Retirement:** At Management's discretion, employees may apply for early retirement with benefits after completing 25 years of continuous service and reaching 50 years of age.

6.16. FINAL SETTLEMENT AND PROPERTY ACCOUNTABILITY

- **Return of Property:** Before the final payment of wages, employees must return all Institution property, including ID cards, records, tools, and instruments.
- **Liability:** Employees are financially liable for any damage caused to the premises or movable property.
- **Non-Compliance:** Failure to return property or settle damages allows the employer to withhold dues, make deductions, or initiate legal action.

CHAPTER – VII

LEAVE AND VACATION POLICY

7.1. GENERAL LEAVE RULES

The primary purpose of granting leave is to provide employees with sufficient rest and relaxation to maintain and enhance professional efficiency.

- **Discretionary Nature:** Leave is not a right; it is a privilege granted subject to the exigencies of service and the availability of alternative arrangements.
- **Application Process:** Employees must apply in writing to the Principal or Correspondent.
- **Short Leave (< 3 days):** Must be submitted at least 48 hours in advance, except on compassionate grounds.
- **Long Leave (> 1 week):** Must be submitted at least 15 days in advance.
- **Approval Workflow:** All applications must include a recommendation from the Head of Department (HOD) before being forwarded to the Principal for final sanctioning.
- **Leave Year:** The leave year is reckoned from January 1 to December 31.
- **Record Keeping:** A formal record of all sanctioned leaves shall be maintained in the employee's personal file and the department's leave register.

Lien on Employment

An employee shall be deemed to have lost their lien on employment if they:

- Absent themselves for 15 consecutive days without notice.
- Overstay sanctioned leave by 8 consecutive days.

Restrictions

- Sundays and public holidays falling within a leave period are counted as part of the leave.
- No leave shall be granted if disciplinary proceedings are pending against the employee.
- Employees on leave may not take up external employment without prior written sanction from the competent authority.
- **Temporary/Part-time Staff:** Eligible only for Casual Leave on a pro-rata basis.

7.2. CASUAL LEAVE (CL)

Casual Leave is intended for urgent personal matters that cannot be planned far in advance.

- **Entitlement:** 15 days per calendar year. Employees joining mid-year receive a pro-rata entitlement.
- **Duration:** Casual Leave cannot be granted for more than three consecutive days at a time.
- **Flexibility:** Casual Leave may be availed in half-day increments and can be prefixed or suffixed to Sundays or statutory holidays.
- **Lapse:** Unavailed Casual Leave shall lapse at the end of the calendar year and cannot be carried forward or accumulated.

7.3. MATERNITY LEAVE

- **Eligibility:** Permanent, married female employees are eligible for three months of maternity leave with full pay.
- **Limitations:** This benefit is restricted to the first two surviving children.
- If an employee applies for maternity leave after having two surviving children, the leave will be treated as **Leave Without Pay (LWP)**.
- Employees who already have two surviving children at the time of joining the institution are not eligible for paid maternity leave.

7.4. MEDICAL LEAVE

- **Entitlement:** 5 days per year with full pay, extendable to 10 days at the discretion of the Management.
- **Documentation:** For medical leave exceeding three days, a medical certificate from an authorized medical practitioner is mandatory.
- **Counting Days:** All intervening Sundays and holidays are counted as part of the medical leave.
- **Vacation Interaction:** Institutional vacations cannot be prefixed or suffixed to medical leave. If medical leave overlaps with a vacation period, the entire duration, including the vacation, will be treated as medical leave and governed by **Leave Without Pay** rules.

7.5. EXTRAORDINARY LEAVE

(LEAVE WITHOUT PAY – LWP)

- **Discretionary Limit:** The principal may grant up to 10 days of LWP per year under extraordinary circumstances. The specific reason for the exigency must be recorded.
- **Extended LWP:** Requests for LWP exceeding 10 days, or extensions of granted leave, may be permitted only for prolonged illness or extreme personal emergencies.
- **Administrative Action:** The Principal must promptly notify the Office Accountant of all LWP approvals for salary adjustments.
- **Unauthorized Absence:** Any employee absent for 10 days without permission beyond the expiry of their LWP shall be liable for strict disciplinary action.

7.6. DUTY LEAVE (OFFICIAL LEAVE)

Duty Leave is granted to employees required to perform official duties or represent the Institution at external venues. Staff members on Duty Leave shall be considered **“On Duty”** for all administrative purposes under the following circumstances:

Examination & Academic Duties

Performing tasks at the direction of the Principal, including but not limited to external invigilation, paper valuation, or conducting practical examinations. Such leave typically ranges from one day to two weeks and requires prior approval from the Principal.

Professional Development

Participation in short-term training programmes, workshops, or in-service education approved by the Institution.

7.7. VACATION ENTITLEMENT

Vacation is a scheduled period of recess; however, it remains subject to the operational requirements of the Institution.

Station Leave

No employee may leave their headquarters during vacation without prior notification to the Head of the Institution. A valid forwarding address and contact details must be provided for emergency communication.

Teaching Staff

Teaching staff are entitled to a vacation period of at least **45 days per academic year**.

Non-Teaching Staff

Non-teaching staff are entitled to a vacation period of not less than **30 days**. This must be scheduled in consultation with the Head of the Institution to ensure the continuous and smooth operation of administrative offices.

Contingent Staff

Contingent staff are entitled to a vacation of not less than **15 days per year**, which may be availed either in a single block or in installments, subject to departmental approval.

7.8. SANCTIONING AUTHORITY

The hierarchy for the approval and sanctioning of leave is as follows:

The Principal

The Principal acts as the primary sanctioning authority for all categories of leave for all staff members, provided the leave falls within standard entitlements such as Casual Leave, Duty Leave, etc.

The President/Management

The President/Management is the final sanctioning authority for **Long Leave exceeding standard limits** and **Extraordinary Leave (Leave Without Pay)**. All such applications must be vetted and recommended by the Principal before being submitted to the President for final approval.